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[00:15:53] House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:16:09] The members will rise and be led in prayer by the Honorable Mike A. Cherry, the Delegate from Colonial Heights. These are your friends. And remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:16:26] Join me in a word of prayer. Dear Heavenly Father, we thank you for this day. We're told in Scripture to come before your throne with thanksgiving and praise. So we thank you for this day. We thank you for this opportunity to come and to be a part of the legislative process to represent those in our districts that have sent us here.

[00:16:46] Father, we're commanded in scripture to pray for those in leadership above us. So we pray for our governor, lieutenant governor, attorney general, for the speaker and the members of this house. Father, we even pray for the members at the other end of the hall that they would have wisdom and understanding. Amen. God, we are so grateful for your eternal love and your mercy and your grace.

[00:17:09] God, we are so grateful that you humbly have given us this opportunity. And God, let us never forget what it is an opportunity to represent and to serve not only you, but the people of our districts. God,

I ask that you bless this day in the name of Jesus.

[00:17:25] Amen. Amen.

[00:17:44] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:18:11] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the journal of the House of Delegates for January 29, 2026. Motions and resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:18:28] Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? Ms. Speaker, not at this time. Therefore, in this first portion of the morning hour pursuant to House Rule 40, use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board. The delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:18:43] I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It is my utmost honor and privilege to welcome back to this chamber my former delegate of the old 90th House District and now Virginia Circuit Court Judge in the Fourth Judicial Circuit.

[00:19:01] Mr. Speaker and members, please welcome back to the floor the Honorable Joseph C. Lindsay. Welcome back, Delegate Judge, whatever I call you, Lindsay.

[00:19:28] Welcome back. I don't want to get in trouble if I have to appear before you. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in gallery, we're joined from the individuals from the Independent Auto Dealers Association.

[00:19:44] Would they please stand? Mr. Speaker, founded in 1960, the Independent Auto Dealers of Virginia was established to give independent automobile dealers a unified voice in Virginia's auto industry. In each and every one of us, we have these dealers in our district.

[00:20:02] They're here to oversight. They provide oversight. We're becoming more structured and formalized as they come to the General Assembly to advocate for their issues. Beginning, the organization has worked collaboratively. I can speak, Mr. Speaker.

[00:20:23] They have worked together with policymakers and state agencies to promote ethical business practices, regulation, and consumer protection. Today, the VIADA represents tens or thousands, over 3,000 now, independent automobile dealers across the Commonwealth, locally owned businesses that provide essential transportation for working families.

[00:20:46] They also create many jobs, strengthen our local economies, and generate significant state and local tax revenue. Through education, compliance, and advocacy, the VIDA continues their long-standing mission of supporting small businesses while protecting consumers and contributing to the Virginia's economy.

[00:21:08] Please join me in thanking the VIDA on everything they've been doing for the last 60 years across the Commonwealth. Would the members of the House please join me in giving the members a warm House welcome? Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:21:31] The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Hearing. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that on page 16, House Bill 492, patron by Delegate Seabold, be re-referred back to the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[00:21:50] Without objection, House Bill 492 is re-referred back to the Committee on Labor and Commerce. Thank you, Mr. Clerk. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction.

[00:22:05] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today is my honor to introduce the students of Senator Stella Pekarski, which is part of my district. Her annual high school leadership program are joining us today. This exceptional group of students come from high schools across both the senator's district as well as my own and are down here in the General Assembly today to learn about the legislative process and experience a day in session.

[00:22:31] So if they are in the gallery, I ask them to stand. I'm excited to welcome these students from Robinson, Westfield, Oakton, Centerville, and Chantilly High Schools to Richmond. We hope to inspire them to pursue careers in public service, and I ask that we extend a warm House welcome.

[00:22:56] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. So at the House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business on a granted leave from today's session. Delegates Knight, McQuinn, Webber, and Williams. Clerk shall announce the next order of this.

[00:23:11] Mr. Speaker, the second portion of the morning hour reserved for member requests to move legislation from an uncontested calendar to, uh, the regular calendar, there are, uh, eight, uh, in that large category, uh, House Bill's second reading uncontested. Um, page four, House Bill, uh, 165, Delegate Thomas, uh, out of the block to the regular calendar at the request of Delegate Wyatt, uh, Wyatt, excuse me. Um, page four, same page, House Bill 170 by Askew, uh, Delegate Askew, again by Delegate Wyatt, uh, over to the regular. Um, on page five,

[00:23:45] House Bill 312 by Delegate Carnegie, House Bill 329 by Delegate McClure, and House Bill 356 by Delegate Thomas. Those are all out at the request of Delegate Simon and Wyatt on the first and Delegate Wyatt on the latter two.

[00:24:01] Page 9, same category, Delegate Cohen's House Bill 460 over at the request of Delegate Wyatt. And finally, same category, up to page 12, Delegate Thomas' House Bill 1188, out of the block over to the regular calendar.

[00:24:18] Kirk will announce the next order of business. And Ms. Speaker, the third portion of the morning hour, remember, requests for legislation go by for the day, and if such, the subsequent motion by the majority leader will effectuate that. There are two. Page 4, Delegate Simons, HB 264.

[00:24:36] That would be by for the day, request to Delegate Tran. And on page 9, Delegate asks you House Bill 544 a bye for the day. There's the only two of which I'm aware. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:24:59] Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk shall

announce the next order. And, Mr. Speaker, the fourth and bottom portion of the morning hour is heard for member requests.

[00:25:15] for points of personal privilege. - Clerk will call the calendar. - Calendar for today, Friday, January 30th, 2026. First category, House bills on third reading, regular four bills in this category.

[00:25:33] They begin with page one, House Bill 187, providing a charter for the city of Virginia Beach related to city council voting districts. - Shall the bills pass?

[00:25:56] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 83, noes 13, abstentions 1. Ayes, 83, noes 13, abstentions 1, the bill passes. Over on page 2, continuing with this category, House Bill 62, now before you, would provide a charter for the town of Tazewell in Tazewell County relating to town manager.

[00:26:16] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 96, noes 1.

[00:26:33] Ayes, noes 1, the bill passes. House Bill 98, providing a charter for the town of Glenlyn in Giles County. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:26:53] Ayes 96, noes 0. Ayes 96, noes 0. The bill passes. And House Bill 657, providing a new charter of the town of Louisa and Louisa County. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:27:18] Ayes 93, noes 1. Ayes 93, noes 1. The bill passes. Continuing with today's calendar, next category. House bills on a second reading, uncontested calendar.

[00:27:36] Some 20-ish bills in this category, now beginning top of page three of the printing calendar. House Bill 32, which seeks to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to the Commissioner of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services, Duties, Problem Gaming Treatment and Support Advisory Committee appointment of members.

[00:27:56] Legislation report committee on health and human services. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the body. House Bill 32 expands the membership of the Problem Gambling Treatment and Support Advisory Committee to include two new positions, an employee at the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services who specializes in recovery and treatment services and a representative from the Virginia State Police Gaming Enforcement Unit.

[00:28:21] Established by my 23 legislation to enable collaboration among prevention and treatment providers and operators of legal gaming in the Commonwealth on efforts to reduce the negative effects of problem gambling, These additional appointments are going to better assist the committee in fulfilling its mission. I've been to a few of the committee meetings, and I know this will be very helpful.

[00:28:40] I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up in the block, House Bill 39, which speaks to amend and reenact different sections of the Code of Virginia, this time relating to duty of settlement agent, restricted covenants, legislation reporting on general laws. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon.

[00:28:58] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, what this bill does, we passed a bill about six or seven years ago that makes it possible for people to remove illegal restrictive racial covenants from the title of their property. We have a form and a process to do that. The issue is not a lot of people know that that process exists yet. So what this bill does is it creates a disclosure. At the time of settlement, you'll get a note as you're signing your closing documents, says, hey, we found some of these illegal racial covenants in your title when we did your title search. If you'd like to remove them from your title, this is the process.

That's what the bill does. Hopefully, it'll encourage people to use the new process. I hope it's the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading.

[00:29:32] Next up in the block, House Bill 114, which would direct the State Corporation Commission to conduct a comprehensive analysis of existing electric utility infrastructure. Legislative support committee on labor and commerce with an amendment to substitute. The delegate from Powhatan, delegate where?

[00:29:48] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The bill with the substitute now directs the Energy Department in consultation with the State Corporation Commission to study potential investments in existing power plants, transmission lines, and distribution systems in the Commonwealth to identify cost savings investments that can reduce the need for greenfield projects.

[00:30:17] The bill also directs the SEC to evaluate voluntary pathways for new large utility customers to directly finance these retrofits, which would insulate everyday utility customers from these costs.

[00:30:33] I hope it would be the pleasure of the House to engross the bill and pass it on to its third read. Ms. Speaker, continuing, Ward notwithstanding, if you're following along on the printed calendar, pages 4 and 5 of the printed calendar, House Bills 165, House Bill 170, House Bill 264, House Bill 312, House Bill 329, and House Bill 356 have all been moved.

[00:31:02] out of the block to the regular calendar, and then over on page 6, House Bill 371 likewise has been moved out of the block to the regular calendar. So continuing with the block, the bill now before us is House Bill 391. House Bill 391, patron by Delegate Askew, as legislation to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to medical cannabis program, product labels delivery.

[00:31:25] Legislation reporting on general laws with amendments. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate, ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, as amended, HB 391 is a narrow update to our medical cannabis program.

[00:31:44] It's a bill that we passed last year in a similar form. This improves patient safety and access. It also modernizes labeling so patients know what they're taking. Edibles, topical labeled in milligrams, inhalable products labeled with TAC and or CBD percentage.

[00:32:00] So dosing is clear and consistent. It also preserves delivery for patients who live far from a dispensary while prohibiting delivery to high-risk locations like military bases, schools, the Capitol, and other public large events. I hope it's a willed by to engross this bill and pass it to its third reader.

[00:32:17] Mr. Speaker, I just misspoke. On page 4, Delegate Simon's bill, House Bill 264, that I'd said we've actually moved that to the regular calendar. It's actually by for the day. So I apologize for that. But it will be on the regular calendar tomorrow, next time we meet.

[00:32:35] So I apologize for that. It's inadvertent. Continuing with the calendar, we're over on page 7, the printed version. House Bill 426 now before you. This legislation to amend and reenact Texas Code of Virginia relating to workers' compensation, employers, offset, and event of recovery.

[00:32:50] This legislation to put a committee on labor and commerce with an amendment. Delegate from Henrico. Delegate Laverie-Bowley. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of labor and commerce

amendments. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate LaVere Bowling.

[00:33:06] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill clarifies that when an injured worker receives a third-party recovery, their workers' compensation benefits are not suspended but instead reduced proportionally until the employer's credit is exhausted. It protects continuity of medical care and income for injured workers while preserving employers' existing offset rights.

[00:33:24] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. House Bill, excuse me, House Bill 431, different bills, same patron. This one amends and reenacts portion of the Code of Virginia related to Alzheimer's Disease and Related Disorders Commission. Extension of expiration date, Legislation Support Committee on Rules.

[00:33:42] The delegate from Henrico, Delegate of the Barry Bowling. Mr. Speaker, HB 431 renews Virginia's Alzheimer's Disease and Related Disorders Commission, which supports families and caregivers as dementia impacts more and more Virginians across the Commonwealth. Caregivers, especially in rural and underserved communities, are often balancing work, family, and complex care needs with little coordination or support, and this commission does, in fact, provide that relief.

[00:34:06] Extending the commission ensures that continuity and accountability as Virginians work to become a more dementia-capable Commonwealth. And with that, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed through his third reading. Over on page 8, House Bill 433 seeks to amend and reenact section. Dakota, Virginia, related to newborn screening, evaluation of disorders for inclusion.

[00:34:25] Legislation, again, reporting committee on rules, this time with an amendment, nature of substitute. The delegate from Henrico, the delegate LaVere Bowling Show. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the subcommittee amendments. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[00:34:40] All those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate LaVere Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill modernizes Virginia's newborn screening program by establishing a clear evidence-based process for adding new conditions as medical science evolves. The substitute directs the Department of Health to evaluate these conditions using defined criteria, timelines, and stakeholder input, rather than locking specific disorders into statute. It's going to strengthen transparency and accountability through annual reporting to the GA while ensuring fiscal responsibility and program integrity. And with that, Mr. Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and passed in the third reading.

[00:35:15] Act 4 is House Bill 434, legislation to amend the Code of Virginia-related electric utilities, grid utilization programs, annual report, legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce as well, again, with a amendment and a substitute. Nobody likes a show-off.

[00:35:33] The delegate from MIRACO, Delegate LeVere Bowley. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate LeVere Bowley. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill puts ratepayers first by requiring utilities and regulators to fully assess exactly how well our existing electric grid is performing before approving expensive new infrastructure that shows up on customer bills.

[00:35:57] The substitute itself strengthens reliability planning by requiring transparent grid utilization metrics, evaluating performance during peak demand, and ensuring the SEC has the tools to hold utilities

accountable. And with that, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed your third reading. You done?

[00:36:15] Ms. Speaker, continuing with this uncontested second reading block, next up is House Bill 453, which seeks to amend and reenact portion of the Code of Virginia related to comprehensive crisis system, Marcus Alert system, powers and duties of the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services related to comprehensive mental health, substance abuse, and developmental disability crisis services written plan. Legislative support the Committee on Health and Human Services with an amendment.

[00:36:38] Delegate from Henrico. Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. If Henrico has not used up its bill allotment, I would like to move the committee amendment. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate Willett.

[00:36:53] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking of the bill, HB 453 allows the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services, in collaboration with the Department of Criminal Justice Services, to amend the Marcus Alert State Plan. I think most of us are familiar with the Marcus Alert Program, which is an excellent program.

[00:37:09] We realize that in the current code, they can't amend the plan. This bill will enable amendments to the plan. And I hope it will be the will of this body to engross this bill and pass it to its third reading. Ms. Speaker, continuing with the calendar, House Bill 460 is out of the block, moved to the regular calendar.

[00:37:25] Page 9, bottom of that page, the printed calendar, House Bill 544, is by for the day. Therefore, top of page 10, continuing with second reading on contested calendar, next up is House Bill 562. It's legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to electric utilities, virtual power plant program cooperatives.

[00:37:44] Legislative support committee on labor and commerce. Delegate from Lownton County, Delegate Reed. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 562 is a follow-on to the legislation we did last year that allowed investor-owned utilities to establish a virtual power plant program. This year, we're doing the same thing for electric co-ops.

[00:38:00] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Continuing with the block, House Bill 572 is now before you. This seeks to amend and reenact a Section of Dakota, Virginia, Related to Uninsured Employers Fund, Administrative Expenses, Legislative Report of the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[00:38:22] Doug from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 572 clarifies that the cost of running Virginia's Uninsured Employers Fund, including administration and legal expenses, can be paid directly out of the fund itself.

[00:38:38] The Uninsured Employers Fund exists to pay workers' compensation benefits when an employer illegally or improperly fails to carry workers' compensation insurance. The bill ensures that the money collected for the fund can also cover the actual cost of administering it, such as third-party administrators, legal fees, and medical audits.

[00:39:01] The bill does not increase taxes and does not change benefit eligibility. It mainly updates how the fund's money can be used. I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and send it on to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 575, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to Respiratory Care Interstate Compact Authorized.

[00:39:23] Legislation was reported this time for the Committee on Health and Human Services. Delegate from Norfolk. Delegate Pass. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 575 will enter Virginia into the Respiratory Care Interstate Compact, allowing respiratory therapists to practice across state lines and expanding their access to care.

[00:39:40] The bill maintains Virginia's regulatory authority while ensuring only licensed and qualified respiratory therapists are eligible. Mr. Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Continuing with block top of page 11, House Bill 579.

[00:40:01] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sexual code of Virginia relating to the interstate massage compact, education and examination requirements, compact commission membership legislation. again reports committee on health and human services uh this time uh with amendments the delegate from norfolk delegate glass gratitude mr speaker i move adoption of the health and human service community committee amendments shall the member be agreed to all those in favor say aye those opposed no the amendment is agreed to the delegate from norfolk gratitude mr speaker the amendments put us in line with fbi requirements for background checks house bill 579 again enters Virginia back into the interstate compact for massage, strengthening education requirements

[00:40:40] for multi-state licensure, and preserves Virginia's regulatory authority while enhancing coordination and oversight through the compact commission. Mr. Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to a third reading. House Bill 712, now before you would direct the Board of Medicine tremendous regulations regarding office-based buprenorphine treatment to require providers to offer counseling or referral to counseling in Legislative Report Committee on Health and Human Service. Delegate from Sussex, Delegate Waxman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 712 merely allows the health care providers of Virginia to take advantage of some

[00:41:16] of the more options for counseling for patients with substance distribution disorder who are receiving bupropenone, and I do hope that it is the pleasure of this body to engross and move the forward thank you sir over on page 12 continuing with the block house bill 860 is legislation that would direct the state board of local and regional jails to convene a work group to review standards and regulations for pregnant and postpartum incarcerated persons in local and regional correction facilities report legislation for the committee on rules from richmond delegate cousins

[00:41:50] thank you mr speaker hb 860 protects the health and well-being of pregnant and postpartum prisoners by directing the board of regional jails to develop health standards and practices, including lactation policies. In developing these recommendations, the board shall consider best practices for screening individuals to determine if they have recently given birth or are currently lactating, providing reasonable accommodations such as access to breast pumps and milk storage, and ensuring appropriate supplemental nutrition. Extensive medical research shows that breastfeeding provides significant health benefits for both infants and their mothers. For incarcerated women,

[00:42:29] the ability to maintain this connection with their newborns can support their rehabilitation. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 1188 is out of the

block to the regular calendar. Therefore, the last bill in the second reading uncontested calendar block is House Bill 1285. House Bill 1285 seeks to amend and reenact Sex Dakota, Virginia relating to State Emergency Medical Services Advisory Board Membership Regional Emergency Medical Services Council's Legislation Report Committee on Health and Human Services. Delegate from Lunenburg, Delegate Wright.

[00:43:02] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen, House Bill 1285 amends the code to reflect the current number of designated regional emergency medical councils. It also aligns the Code of Virginia with the unanimous vote of regional EMS council leadership taken in March 2025, and supports a modernized and financially stable EMS system.

[00:43:29] I move that this bill be moved to his, be engrossed and moved to his third reading. Thank you. Shall the bills be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bills are engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing with today's calendar, new category, House bills on second reading, regular calendar.

[00:43:46] House Bill second reading calendar, page 13, if you're following along that way. First up is House Bill 4, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to preservation of affordable housing, definitions, civil penalty. Legislation was reported depending on general laws. Delicate from Alexandria, Delicate Bennett-Parker.

[00:44:03] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 4 helps us address Virginia's affordable housing crisis. It is a permissive bill for localities that addresses rental buildings that have already received state or federal assistance to create affordable units, for example, through the low-income housing tax credit or LIHTC program. When those affordability restrictions are expiring, after 30 years for LIHTC, and the owner intends to sell the building, the bill would allow localities to establish a right of first refusal if, and only if, they can match a third-party offer.

[00:44:27] The owner receives the same purchase price, and the housing remains affordable. The locality cannot provide a matching offer the owner sells to a third party. These are buildings that have already received public assistance from taxpayers. This is a simple way to make sure that our state investment in affordable housing continues to benefit Virginians. More than 17,000 units of LIHTC-supported affordable housing across Virginia are set to expire in the next few years.

[00:44:47] That is more than 17,000 families at risk of losing affordable housing. We have an affordable housing crisis with these units, and we cannot afford to lose them. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. Delegate from Danville, Delegate Whittle. Mr. Picker, will the delegate yield for a question?

[00:45:04] Will the delegate yield? I yield. Delegate will yield. And what effect will the bill have on private investment and affordable housing? Mr. Speaker, to the delegate, I would say that, again, this is a permissive bill for localities, and it was very narrowly tailored and crafted to have as minimal impact as possible.

[00:45:26] And it would require that the locality has to provide or match a third-party offer in order for the ROFR to take effect. There are also a number of exemptions in the bill for sales and of transfers of ownership or the case of the death of an owner and things like that.

[00:45:42] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 14.

[00:45:58] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act Enforcement by Localities. This legislation reports committee on general laws. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, maybe the fifth time is the charm.

[00:46:14] House Bill 14 would grant localities the authority to enforce the health and safety provisions of the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act and therefore help protect the communities they serve. This would allow local officials to make their communities healthier, protect the rights of tenants, and increase landlord compliance with the provisions.

[00:46:35] This bill has the support of more than 40 organizations, including those on behalf of renters and landlords. So, Mr. Speaker, I hope for the last time that this House would engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third of the reading? All those in favor say aye.

[00:46:51] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third of the reading. House Bill 15, this legislation seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to, again, the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, this time regarding landlord remedies, noncompliance with rental agreement, mandatory waiting period.

[00:47:09] Legislation, again, reports to the Committee on General Laws. Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, again, I hope the fifth time is the charm. House Bill 15 would increase from 5 to 14 days, the time that renters have to pay their rent before the eviction process can begin, allowing renters a chance to receive their next source of income payment to pay the rent in full instead of ending up in costly eviction proceedings.

[00:47:33] As we all know, evictions hurt communities, prevent folks from obtaining safe and secure housing in the future, harm the health and mental health of residents, exacerbate chronic absenteeism for unhoused students, and more. States with 14-day pay-or-quit periods have fewer evictions and keep residents in their homes and have landlords receiving their full payments.

[00:47:55] I move that we would engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Top of page 14, continuing second reading, regular House Bill 27. This legislation seems to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to overtime for certain employees, domestic workers.

[00:48:16] Legislation report committee on labor and commerce with amendment. Delegate from Prince William. Delegate Henson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Prince William. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 27 provides overtime protections for domestic workers, including nannies, house cleaners, caregivers, cooks, and others who provide essential services in private homes across the commonwealth.

[00:48:42] Mr. Speaker, as amended, House Bill 27 addresses the gap by clearly defining domestic services and domestic workers and by expressly including domestic workers under Virginia overtime statute. Mr. Speaker, this bill does have a delayed enactment, effective date of July 1st, 2027.

[00:48:59] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. Following with the second reading regular, House Bill 84, now before you, seeks to amend and re-enact. Secrets Code of Virginia landed electric utilities and licensed suppliers of electricity, regional transmission entities, annual report.

[00:49:20] Legislation was reported to the Committee on Labor and Commerce with amendment nature substitute. And Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron also has a floor amendment drawn to that substitute. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Laufer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[00:49:37] All those in favor say aye. Aye. No, the committee substitutes agree to. As amended, there's an exemption for electric co-ops. And as the clerk has said, Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the floor amendment. Would you like to explain what it does?

[00:49:52] It's speaking to that amendment. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This actually just adds the appropriate code section for electric cooperatives. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:50:07] HB 84 is a simple transparency bill to ensure that PJM is accountable to the ratepayers of Virginia. PJM sells energy to transmission companies in the Commonwealth. Currently, there is no public record of the votes influencing high-level decision-making.

[00:50:23] HB 84 establishes reporting requirements for all votes cast at PJM meetings. This bill will shed light on the decisions affecting electric rates for nearly all Virginians. Electric bills are top of mind, and this bill is a clear opportunity for Virginia to align with an emerging regional standard.

[00:50:41] HB 84 will increase transparency for the ratepayers of Virginia. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. House Bill 95 is legislation to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia Related to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act.

[00:51:02] landlord remedies, non-compliance with rental agreement payment plan. Legislature's reporting on general laws. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Bennett Parker. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 95 offers residents who owe no more than one month's rent a chance to pay their debt through a payment plan before they are evicted.

[00:51:18] Too often, our constituents live paycheck to paycheck. All it takes is one unexpected medical emergency or car repair to impact a resident's ability to make a timely rent payment and go from having a stable home to facing eviction. If a tenant were to miss a payment on their plan under this bill, or if they were to miss a subsequent rent payment, the landlord would still be able to move forward with eviction proceedings.

[00:51:38] In 2024, more than one-third of households evicted were evicted for less than one month's rent. An eviction judgment remains on a person's record indefinitely, even after it has been paid off, and can prevent that person from attaining safe, secure housing for years. This bill will help hardworking Virginians experiencing a temporary hardship remain housed.

[00:51:55] I move that the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up is House Bill 238, legislation to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia relating to labor and employment, payment of wages, minimum wage, and overtime wages, misclassification of workers' civil actions.

[00:52:19] The Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment Nature Substitute. And Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron has two sets of floor amendments that aren't in conflict, and they're available online and to the public as well. So the substitute and two sets of floor amendments.

[00:52:36] The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to speak to and move the line amendment number one. Delegate has the floor.

[00:52:51] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The first line amendment moves the definition of employers to the definition section of the bill And after conversations with the Department of Labor and Industry, I've added belt and suspenders language to make doubly sure that minimum wage violations can be properly enforced. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye.

[00:53:08] All those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Line amendment two, the second line amendments are technical changes in order to clarify that all wage laws still retain a private right of action, Mr. Speaker. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Delegate Lopez.

[00:53:25] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The bill strengthens our ability to protect Virginia workers against wage theft, misclassification, and the failure to pay minimum and overtime wages. Each year, hardworking workers across the Commonwealth are denied legally owed wages. While Virginia already prohibits these practices, enforcement has been badly underfunded, and existing remedies leave workers fearing retaliation if they report violations.

[00:53:48] This bill, Mr. Speaker, will give the Department of Labor and Industry and the Attorney General the tools that they haven't had for a while that they need to better enforce existing wage laws and help protect exploited workers. In an era of historic wage stagnation, too many Virginians are struggling to afford basic necessities.

[00:54:04] I think we have to do all we can to protect the wages that are rightfully and legally owed. Mr. Speaker, I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. New bill, same patron. This one is House Bill 339, which seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia, this time relating to employee protections, prevailing wage, wage and hour, occupational health and safety, and mining safety provisions.

[00:54:31] Legislation, again, reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce, also with an amendment and substitute. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill protects our workers from backsliding labor regulations, ensuring that every Virginian can work under safe and stable conditions.

[00:54:53] The U.S. Department of Labor has been making sweeping efforts to deregulate wage and hour, OSHA, and mining workplace protections, seeking to wholly undermine the nation's regulatory framework. This bill will ensure that all existing worker protections prior to federal deregulations are sustained here in the Commonwealth for the betterment of the wages, health, and safety of Virginia's workforce.

[00:55:14] Workers are facing widespread regressive labor practices, and we have the responsibility, I believe, to ensure that they can safely support their families. Mr. Speaker, I move we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. The delegate from Campbell, Delegate Zaire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I have a question for the patron.

[00:55:32] Will the delegate yield? I yield, Mr. Speaker. The delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I'm wondering if the federal government determines that a regulation is unnecessarily burdensome, why do we in Virginia automatically assume that's wrong? The delegate from Arlington, Doug Lopez. Mr. Speaker, I would say that if in the language of the bill, it simply gets into the specifics of if, according to the commissioner of Doley, they believe, or the secretary, if they believe that it has become less stringent than, Mr. Speaker, less protective of the safety of, say, mine workers or the safety of someone working in a manufacturing plant, that we can do better.

[00:56:11] We can help protect our workers in a way that maybe the federal government doesn't want to. And the fact is, Mr. Speaker, that we can actually go further and be more protective than national standards. And I think it's important that we always try to do as right by our workers as possible.

[00:56:31] That sounds like states' rights. The delegate for you have another question. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Turn to page 16. Next up, House Bill 469. Legislation would direct the Department of Medical Assistance Services to amend autism competencies checklist regulations to allow positive behavior support facilitators to conduct training sessions on such competencies. Legislation report committing on health and human services.

[00:57:06] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 469 requests that DMASC amend their regulations related to autism competencies checklist. to include positive behavior support facilitators as trainers of direct support professionals and direct support professional supervisors. This comes endorsed by the Autism Advisory Council.

[00:57:27] I ask that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 492 has been re-referred to the Committee on Labor and Commerce. Therefore, next up, second reading regular is House Bill 574, top of page 17.

[00:57:43] This legislation seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to Athletic Trainer Compact. Legislative Support Committee on Health and Human Services. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Glass. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 574 enters Virginia into the Athletic Trainer Compact, allowing it licensed athletic trainers to practice across state lines and improving continuity of care.

[00:58:02] The bill preserves Virginia's full regulatory authority while establishing a consistent licensure per standards among participating states. Mr. Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[00:58:18] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 727 is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to local boards of social services, appointments, terms of office. Legislation again reports Committee on Health and Human Services. Senator Frank O'Connor, Delegate Davis.

[00:58:34] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 727 simply allows local board members of the Department of Social Services to serve three terms, consecutive terms, as current law only allows for two. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[00:58:51] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. And next up is House Bill 1377, legislation to establish the Virginia Military Institute Advisory Task Force.

[00:59:08] Legislation report committee on rules with an amendment in nature to substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Committee substitutes agreed to. Delegate from Fairfax. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 1377 seeks to establish a task force and have a report as to the extent to which the Virginia Military Institute has followed up on the recommendations of Chev from the 2021 report that found multiple instances of sexism, racism, and sexual assault.

[00:59:44] assault at VMI. It also makes sure that VMI has taken adequate steps, as recommended in the report and elsewhere, to distance itself from the Confederacy. We know today still cadets at VMI attend class in Maury Hall and Scott Ship Hall, celebrating two Confederate officers.

[01:00:02] They attend class in the Mallory Hall, celebrating a Confederate Secretary of the Navy. Every graduate today has emblazoned on the rings as they graduate from VMI. the date of the Battle of Haymarket in which VMI cadets marched out in a spectacular act of treason and fired on United States troops in defense of slavery.

[01:00:24] This is a taxpayer-funded institution, one in which we should celebrate the goals, the laudable goals of producing great leaders of character like a hero of mine, General Marshall, but also one in which we need to make sure that they're moving forward. All this does is build a task force and a report to make sure that we have taken adequate action.

[01:00:44] And I think, and it is my hope, that VMI and its board embraces this as a way to move forward and make sure that we continue to produce leaders of character in the best interest of the commonwealth. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Barnatine, Delegate Austin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:01:00] Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1377 creates a task force to review the conduct of actions, as stated by the patron of Virginia Military Institute. Virginia Military Institute was founded in 1839.

[01:01:17] It's a public institute, four-year military college, offering undergrad, bachelor's of arts, bachelor's of science degrees with 14 majors, 28 minors, academic concentrations in engineering, science, and the humanities. VMI has produced a number of graduates of character who have contributed to the Commonwealth and the United States, including General George C. Marshall and civil rights martyr Jonathan M. Daniels.

[01:01:44] Over 200 alum officers have reached the rank of flag officer in the United States Armed Forces. Over 300 alum have given their lives in military service to the United States. All of the above was taken from the resolution creating the task force.

[01:01:59] As stated, Mr. Speaker, in my opinion, these qualities well represent VMI's contribution to the Commonwealth and the nation. Mr. Speaker, I understand in today's world there have been problems.

[01:02:17] There have been probably, back up, Mr. Speaker, let me say this again. I'm more like Delegate Wyatt. I can't talk today. Mr. Speaker, I understand in today's world there have probably been changes in behavior and actions that possibly should have been incorporated into VMI.

[01:02:35] Certainly, VMI has reacted to some of those, but maybe not all. I would hope, Mr. Speaker, it is the intent of this body and the task force to give the opportunity to work with VMI to become a better and stronger institution. Mr. Speaker, as you know, VMI is in my House District 37.

[01:02:54] I've had the privilege of representing VMI for four years. The Institute's longevity and community involvement, along with the participation in civic organizations in Lexington, are an integral part of the community. Mr. Speaker, VMI's legacy has become a foundation in Lexington, Rockbridge County, and the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[01:03:14] Mr. Speaker, as stated before, I and others stand ready and willing to work with anyone to make VMI a better institution. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:03:34] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, returning to the number of bills that were pulled out of the block, going back to page four, of the printing calendar, if you're following that way, picking up House Bill now before you, 165.

[01:03:53] This legislation seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to a board of contract, a board for contract, excuse me, examinations, alternative languages, legislation with the Board of Committee on General Laws. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 165 would permit those wishing to become contractors to take a limited set of contracting exams in their preferred language.

[01:04:15] Right now, two languages that would qualify for such a bill would be Spanish and Vietnamese. Mr. Speaker, the board is not correct. House of B&E's.

[01:05:07] I'm in order.

[01:05:50] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As it is a Friday, I'll try to just pick up where I left off. The bill is self-funded with a $1 to $2, $3 increase in the cost just for that

subset of 50 exams. I hope it's the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should it be a bill engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:06:07] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The Bill's Engrossed and passed the third reading. Excuse me. Next up, same page, House Bill 170. This one, legislation for Delegate Askew seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to real estate appraisers, educational requirements for licensure, anti-discrimination training.

[01:06:24] This legislation is reported as well for the Committee on General Laws with the amendment of the nature of a substitute. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move to Committee Substitute. Shall the Committee Substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The Committee Substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 176 to improve training of appraiser biases and break down other barriers that we've seen in this industry by requiring education and fair housing laws, instruction that is provided or approved by fair housing experts as a mean of obtaining and maintaining an appraisal license.

[01:06:57] We can address the key cause of bias in the housing market. This bill, again, requires applicants for appraisal licensors to complete an anti-discrimination training course approved by the Fair Housing Board as part of their training to become an appraiser. This ensures that Virginia law aligns with the new appraiser qualifications criteria created by the Appraisal Foundation that went to effect at the beginning of this year.

[01:07:17] I hope it's the ability to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 264 is by for the day. Therefore, the bill before you next is House Bill 312. It seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to motor vehicle glass repair and replacement penalties legislation was important committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute daily from chesapeake delegate carnegie thank you mr speaker i move the committee substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye all those opposed no committee substitute is agreed to thank you mr speaker house bill 12 as substituted is

[01:07:54] focused is a focused consumer protection and safety bill the substitute removes insurer related provisions already covered under title 38.2 avoiding duplication and conflicting enforcement This bill instead creates a Motor Vehicle Glass Act under Title 59.1 enforced through the Virginia Consumer Protection Act with a focus on transparency and safety, particularly regarding advanced driver assistance system calibration following glass repairs.

[01:08:19] I hope it is the pleasure of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, does the delegate yield for a question? Will the delegate yield? The delegate does not yield for a question. Okay, the delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Lefwich.

[01:08:57] The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Lefwich. I would ask the delegate if she would yield for a question. Would the delegate yield? The delegate will yield. Aww. The delegate will yield. I have no question, Mr. Speaker.

[01:09:16] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[01:09:31] Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Gotta love her Friday. Continuing, next up, House Bill 308. and 29, the Legislation Exterminate Reenact, three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, Manufactured Home Lot Rental Act, Retaliatory Conduct Prohibited.

[01:09:54] Legislation Report Committee on General Laws. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 329 strengthens protections for tenants facing retaliation from their landlord. This bill expands the definition of retaliatory acts and protected tenant activities. Mr. Speaker, this bill also adds in guardrails so that landlords cannot be held liable if they did not have knowledge of the tenant's actions.

[01:10:17] Mr. Speaker, we have worked really hard with stakeholders, which include large and small landlords, in drafting this bill. This bill was passed out of this body in bipartisan vote in 2024, and I'm proud to continue to have peace in the valley and support from landlords on this important measure.

[01:10:34] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 356 is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Housing and Community Development, local housing policy, report to department. Legislation report committee on general laws.

[01:10:57] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 356 would broaden the scope of data that a current already existing report from localities to DHCD would require. It would broaden the types of housing units that are denied, most importantly, and puts a definition that if a housing permit takes longer than 12 months, it is now counted as a denial in order to help us here at the state level make better housing decisions.

[01:11:20] I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 6 of the printed calendar bill before you next is House Bill 371, Legislation amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Commission to end hunger.

[01:11:40] Membership, legislation report for the committee on rules. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 371 adjusts the membership requirements for the commission to end hunger. We were ambitious in thinking that we could get a physician and a high school student, but they were both unable to come at our meetings that are usually scheduled at 10 a.m. to 2 p.m.

[01:12:00] So we are adjusting that to be a representative from school nutrition and a licensed health care provider with knowledge of nutrition and hunger. And because we still value the input of students, we would like to create five public school liaisons, one from each of the health regions, in order to get input from the youth.

[01:12:19] I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. And turning to page 9, the printed calendar, the final two bills picking up in this second reading regular, House Bill 460 now before you.

[01:12:38] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity, Employment Services Organizations, Legislation Report Committee on General Laws. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 460 directs the Department of Small Business and Supplier Diversity to amend relevant regulations of the Virginia Administrative Code to reflect the intent of the General Assembly to specifically reference employment service organizations in the relevant regulations concerning state procurement. I ask that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:13:11] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to the third reading. and last bill page 12 print encounter house bill 1188 now before you seeks to amend the code of virginia land of the virginia boys and men advisory commission established report legislation report committee on rules with amendment nature substitute down from prince william delegate thomas thank you mr speaker i move the committee substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the committee substitute is agreed to thank you mr speaker mr speaker house bill 1188 as substituted we create the first in the nation

[01:13:46] Committee at the state level on men and boys. It would consist of 23 members, the majority being legislators, eight House members, four senators, and several civilians from various places or various qualifications like mental health, K-12, and workforce development. The committee is narrowly tailored in mission to look at educational inequity, economic opportunities, disparity in health outcomes, family life, and the impact of social media use. I would Also note that this is emergency legislation, so on third read, we will need everyone's participation on a bipartisan bill that is chief code by two of my great friends across the aisle,

[01:14:23] and look forward to making Virginia the leader in improving men's health for men and boys. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:14:39] Continuing with today's calendar, page 18, new category, resolutions, uncontested calendar. Three bills in this block, beginning with House Joint Resolution 16, continuing the Joint Subcommittee on Recurrent Flooding Report, Legislation Report Committee on Rules. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Converse Fowler.

[01:14:56] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 16 will extend the work to be done by the Joint Subcommittee on Recurrent Flooding for an extra year to align with the terms of the House of Delegates members. Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of this resolution. Continuing with the Block House Joint Resolution 18, House Joint Resolution 18 by, patron by Delegate McQuinn, who is not here today, relating to a portrait of the Honorable Yvonne Bond Miller.

[01:15:26] This legislation also was reported unanimously by the Committee on Rules. The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Can this bill go by, this resolution go by temporarily? Without objection, the bill goes by temporarily.

[01:15:44] Mr. Speaker, then continuing with this uncontested calendar block, House Resolution 4 is legislation expressing support for participation by Virginia in the Southern Regional Education Board's Crisis Recovery Support Network.

[01:16:01] This legislation was reported by the Committee on Rules. The delegate from Colonial Heights, Delegate Chair. Thank you Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HR 4 is a simple committing resolution for the Southern Region Education Board which has created a crisis recovery network. This network is comprised of over 150 school counselors from the 16 states that make up SREB and in the event of a traumatic situation like a school shooting, a teacher committing suicide or something like that, these counselors would be available to go to those schools and to commit up to a year to help with the trauma that's been incurred.

[01:16:37] this I ask that it be the will of the body to pass this resolution and miss speaker returning to pay to house joint resolution 18 they went by temporarily delegate from Alexandra Delegate Henry thank you mr. speaker I move that this resolution go by for the day without objection house joint resolution 18 goes

[01:17:00] by for the day shall the bills for the resolutions pass

[01:17:40] close the roll miss speaker ayes 96 no zero eyes 96 no zero the resolutions are adopted. And finally, last bill, last category, resolutions regular calendar. One piece of legislation in this category, it is House Joint Resolution 34, a requested Department of Taxation to study options for abolishing personal property taxation of certain qualifying vehicles. This legislation was reported from the Committee on Rules. Delegate for Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the resolution. Delegate has the floor. House Joint

[01:18:16] Resolution 34 directs the Department of Taxation to study how to repeal the car tax, the most hated tax in the Commonwealth. I'm a fifth-generation Southwest Virginian. In hometowns all across Virginia, this revenue supports public safety, local schools, and the Friday night lights that hold our communities together. House Joint Resolution 34 is a responsible and thoughtful first step to deliver relief for families while ensuring our local services like our teachers, our firefighters and public and our police remain fully funded and have the support that they need. Mr. Speaker, I move the resolution be adopted. The delegate from Scott

[01:18:53] County, Delegate Kilgore. Speak to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, this session is supposed to be about affordability. We've heard that time and time again. And if you really want to make life more affordable, we start doing away with this car tax. We don't need a study. We all know what it costs, but we can intermittently take this car tax away. If we start at $5,000, I think the gentleman from Salem had that bill, we could start really helping citizens make their life more affordable. Like I say, we know what the cost

[01:19:30] is going to be. There's no reason in studying this and studying this and kicking the can down the road i hope that the majority party would look at this in the budget process and decide that we can do some of this i know the governor came out for this during the campaign so i just hope that we can all work together in a bipartisan matter be nice about it and pass pass a car tax this year

[01:19:57] thank you shall the resolution be agreed to mr clerk clerk will close the roll eyes 68 nose 25 I-68, nose 25. The resolution is agreed to.

[01:20:30] Mr. Speaker, that completes work on today's calendar. Per House Rule 51. I was waiting on that. A little slow on the uptake, but it's okay.

[01:20:51] Per House Rule 51, the House will return to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communications. I have several announcements. First, there is a supplemental calendar, number one, for this Friday, January 30th. Senate bill is on second reading. There are a couple of them, and then some others.

[01:21:07] Just remind the body, with Senate bills coming over, unlike House bills, when Senate bills come over, we're going to committee, referred to committee as first reading, coming out as second reading. It's an informational purpose only, and then we amend debate and vote on third reading of Senate bill legislation.

[01:21:24] Then there's other House legislation on there. I also remind the body that on Monday when we return, this weekend, your statement of economic interest is due by midnight, 11.59.59 p.m. on Monday. So plan accordingly for that, please.

[01:21:40] And then looking ahead to today's meeting schedule, committee on appropriations, 15 minutes. 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House up on the 12th floor appropriations room. Once the full committee is done, three of its subcommittees are going to meet. Government and general, excuse me, general government and capital outlay will meet first once the full committee is finished.

[01:21:56] Then once that subcommittee is done, then elementary and secondary education will meet. And then health and human resources subcommittee will meet. So probes and then three of its subcommittees all up on the 12th floor of the General Assembly Building. Fifteen minutes after adjournment of the House, Courts of Justice Criminal Subcommittee is going to meet.

[01:22:16] They'll be in House Room C on the second floor, and same time, 15 minutes upon adjournment, approximately 2.15, 2.20-ish, the Courts of Justice Civil Subcommittee, but they'll be down the hall at the House North Subcommittee Room on the second floor. Full Courts of Justice Committee is foregoing meeting time in lieu for it.

[01:22:36] subcommittees to work through their dockets. Looking ahead to Monday, February 2nd, Groundhog Day, the Committee on Finance, subcommittee number one, will be meeting at 7 a.m. in House Committee Room B on the second floor. At 7.30, the Committee on Rules as Studies subcommittee will be meeting again this time in the House North subcommittee room on the second floor. That's at 7.30. At 8 o'clock, Committee on Education is meeting in House Committee Room A on the lower level. Once the full committee is finished, then it's Higher Education Subcommittee of the Committee on Education. They'll be meeting both of those in House Room A. At 8 a.m., the Communications,

[01:23:16] Technology, and Innovations Committee's Communications Subcommittee will meet at 8 in House Committee Room C on the second floor. And then at 10 o'clock, the full committee is meeting of the CT&I. So that'll all be in House Room C. And then Democratic caucuses, Republican caucuses will be meeting before we go into session. Democratic caucuses at 11.15 and Republican caucus at 11.30. 11 a.m.

[01:23:41] So 11 a.m. for the Republicans, 11.15 for the Democratic caucus. And, Ms. Speaker, that completes all the announcements I have. Yes, sir. And finally, Ms. Speaker, just remind the body, it looks like the snow's coming in, so plan accordingly. We will try to stay abreast of it.

[01:24:09] We're doing ceremonial swearing-ins tomorrow for many of the remaining members. Sounds like it's supposed to start tomorrow. Southeast Hampton Roads is supposed to be getting more of it. We're on the line between here and there. So if we hear anything, we will let you know.

[01:24:24] So maybe keep an eye on what's going on when you go home. But be safe, and we will try to keep you informed as best we can. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene on Monday at 12 noon.

[01:24:39] The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene Monday at 12 noon. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring, moves that the House do now adjourn.

[01:24:55] As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the House do now adjourn until Monday at 12 noon.